



Entry-level Graphics Cards										
Brand Model Name	EVGA 9600GT KO	MSI 9600GT ZILENT	Palit 9600 GT 1GB SONIC	Palit 9600 GSO SONIC	Calibre 9500GT	GIGABYTE 9500GT OC	Palit 9500 GT SUPER	Palit 9500 GT SUPER 1 GB	POV 9500 GT 512MB DDR2	Sparkle 9500GT
										
GPU Name	9600 GT	9600 GT	9600 GT	9600 GSO	9500 GT	9500 GT	9500 GT	9500 GT	9500 GT	9500 GT
Price (Rs)	7500	13000	8750	6500	6250	8500	4250	5350	4250	4100
Total Score (Out of 100)	79.59	77.55	80.00	67.76	37.75	28.47	23.17	23.38	23.13	24.27
Features (Out of 30)	23.88	23.26	24.00	20.33	11.33	8.54	6.95	7.01	6.94	7.28
Performance (Out of 70)	55.71	54.28	56.00	47.43	26.43	19.93	16.22	16.37	16.19	16.99
Features										
Core Speed (MHz)	700	700	700	600	600	650	550	550	550	550
Memory Speed (MHz)	1900	1900	2000	1600	1800	1800	800	800	800	800
No Of Stream Processors	64	64	64	96	32	32	32	32	32	32
VRAM Type	GDDR3	GDDR3	GDDR3	GDDR3	GDDR3	DDR2	DDR2	DDR2	DDR2	DDR2
Amount of VRAM (In Megabytes)	512	1024	1024	384	512	512	512	1024	512	512
Memory Bus Width (In Bits)	256	256	256	192	128	128	128	128	128	128
GPU Fabrication Process	65nm	65nm	65nm	65nm	65nm	65nm	65nm	65nm	65nm	65nm
No of DVI Ports	2	2	2	2	2	2	1	1	1	1
Dual Monitor Support (Y/N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
HDMI (Y/N)	N	Y (Adapter)	Y	N	N	Y (adapter)	N	N	N	N
Accessory / Connector Bundle	S-Video to component adapter, 4 pin power adapter, DVI to D-Sub adapter	S-Video to component adapter, 4 pin power adapter, DVI to D-Sub adapter	4 pin power adapter, DVI to D-Sub adapter	S-Video to component adapter, 4 pin power adapter, DVI to D-Sub adapter	S-Video to component adapter, 4 pin power adapter, DVI to D-Sub adapter, Composite Video Cable	DVI to D-Sub adapter	NA	NA	NA	S-Video to component adapter, 4 pin power adapter, DVI to D-Sub adapter
Game Bundle	N	N	Tomb Raider	NA	N	N	N	N	N	N
Performance										
Crysis										
1280 x 1024 (Max Detail, 4x AA)	26.26	25	26.44	24.56	11.1	7.34	6.03	6.45	6.09	6.49
1024 x 768 (Max Detail, No AA)	34.21	33.4	34.46	32.66	14.66	11.09	9.12	9.21	8.99	9.2
Unreal Tournament 3 (Deimos)										
1280 x 1024 (8 xAF, 4x AA, Max Detail)	93	93	93	85	50	40	33	33	32	33
1024 x 768 (4x AF, No AA, Max Detail)	103	102	102	96	72	57	49	51	48	49
S.T.A.L.K.E.R. Shadow of Chernobyl										
1280 x 1024 (4xAF, 4x AA, Max Detail)	116.93	111.37	117.61	92.93	56	44	35.13	34.64	31.61	36.43
1024 x 768 (4x AF, No AA, Max Detail)	159.85	151.34	159.37	130.72	80.22	63.58	51.68	50.35	54.97	53.85
Company of Heroes: Opposing Fronts										
1280 x 1024 (4x AF, No AA, Max Detail)	119.3	113.4	112.9	106.1	56	48.3	40.4	41.2	41.4	40.6
World In Conflict										
1280 x 1024 (4x AF, 4x AA, Max Detail)	27	27	28	19	14	9	7	7	7	8
1024 x 768 (4x AF, No AA, Medium Detail)	52	54	52	45	31	43	46	46	46	39
F.E.A.R (Avg FPS)										
1280 x 1024 (4x AA, 4x AF, Max Detail)	100	96	101	72	46	34	26	27	26	28
3D Mark Vantage (GPU Sco re)	4175	3940	4183	3723	1767	1417	1118	1028	1132	1137

Performance

OnlyCalibre,GigabyteandZOTAC fiddled with the GPU cores of their cards – while Calibre boosted clocks from the default 550 MHz to 600 MHz, both Gigabyte and ZOTAC went with healthy overlocks of 100 MHz over stock speeds. One very important fac-

tor affecting these cards’ performance (as we discovered) is their memory subsystems. Since these are low end chipsets all vendors have fiddled around with memory options. Some have offered DDR2 memory which adversely affects bandwidth and therefore overall performance. Only three

vendors supplied fast GDDR3 memory with their cards – XFX, Calibre and ZOTAC and these cards were the fastest in this category. In fact the difference that GDDR3 makes is startling – and makes a strong advertisement for advocating its use over DDR2 memory.

GeForce 9400 GT

Not for gaming

The GeForce 9400 GT is a value chipset intended to replace the ageing GeForce 8400 GS which has done a stellar job of keeping the entry-level segment firmly in NVIDIA’s grasp.

Anyone looking for a graphics card that can handle the demands of a multimedia PC or an HTPC will definitely not want something costly. The GeForce 8400 GS can be had for as little as Rs 1,800. For a graphics card with DX 10 support, 16 SPs and 128 MB of dedi-

cated video memory we feel this isn’t a bad deal. The 9400 GT adds a little more performance to the 8400 GS while reducing the already miniscule power requirements. Although people interested in gaming should not look at these cards we reckon they can handle most of the